coach or a leader. If there is an issue to be thrashed out, it must be done on a one-to-one basis.

Andy's style was to frame everything in a team context. Typically, he would say, 'Well, what went wrong this week? I thought we took our eye off the ball.' He'd then ask a player for his thoughts. It took me back to those days at school, when you are day-dreaming in class, and snap back into the present thinking, 'Shit! I hope the teacher doesn't ask me a question now …'

As we gained more confidence in each other, developed trust and ease in each other's company, those awkward silences became shorter. We weren't afraid to be self-critical, or critical of others, within reason. Obviously, the management of that is hard, because once you throw a meeting open you don't know what is going to be tossed back at you.

Failure is a touchy subject. Occasionally, an argument is going to be created by a loose word or a thoughtless comment, but that comes with the territory. I resolved to rebuild faith through the infusion of new players and coaches. Different personalities can help to restore a sense of momentum, provided they are loyal to the common themes of the group.

I had no active role in the selection process but was happy when Peter Moores was appointed as Andy's successor in April 2014, before the summer series against Sri Lanka and India. He was a familiar figure who offered a different voice and had re-evaluated his approach following his first spell in charge. I liked him as a person, already related to him as a coach, and he understood what made me tick.

I had come up with a list of non-negotiables for what I regarded as the second stage of my captaincy. These revolved around the principle of being an England player 24/7. It didn't involve a grand gesture, a PowerPoint sermon. I'd seen enough of those to doubt their effectiveness. It was more intimate, a renewal of our vows to one another as tried and trusted teammates.

My plan, scribbled in a little black book, included a commitment to reconnecting with the cricket public. We needed to rediscover our sense of freedom, reaffirm what it meant to us to play for England. We had a team charter that had run its course, but we still needed a simple set of rules to live, play and work by. This wasn't revolution. It was an evolution that recognized strengths we hadn't made the most of. No one was going to come riding in on a cloud of glory to save us. We had to do it for ourselves.